IDEATION PHASE

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date: 31 January 2025

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Project Name: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Maximum Marks: 4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

Reference: https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization

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Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

1.1 Team Gathering and Collaboration

The team gathered to discuss the existing IT procurement process for standard laptop orders. The team members shared their understanding of how laptop requests are submitted, approved, and processed in the ServiceNow Service Catalog.

During the discussion, the team focused on identifying activities that require manual effort and may cause delays in providing laptops to users.

The team discussed the following areas:

- Standard laptop request process.
- Service Catalog ordering.
- Request approval process.
- Creation of configuration tasks.
- Assignment of tasks to the Hardware team.
- Tracking of laptop configuration.
- Reduction of manual work.
- Improvement of user experience.
- Automation using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

The team agreed that the laptop configuration task is an important part of the procurement process because the laptop must be configured before it can be provided to the user.

1.2 Problem Identification

The existing process may require manual intervention after a Standard Laptop request is approved. The configuration task needs to be created and assigned to the Hardware team.

Manual task creation can result in:

- Delay in creating the configuration task.
- Additional workload for the IT procurement team.
- Possibility of forgetting or overlooking a task.
- Inconsistent task information.
- Delay in assigning the task to the Hardware team.
- Increased waiting time for users.

Therefore, the team identified the need for an automated process.

1.3 Selected Problem Statement

Problem Statement:

> The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

1.4 User Story

> As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

1.5 Project Objective

The main objective of the project is to implement an automated workflow using **ServiceNow Flow Designer** to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops.

The project aims to:

1. Provide a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops.
2. Ensure timely configuration of standard laptops.
3. Reduce manual intervention.
4. Reduce the possibility of human errors.
5. Improve resource utilization.
6. Automatically create configuration tasks.
7. Automatically assign tasks to the Hardware team.
8. Improve the overall efficiency of the IT procurement process.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

2.1 Brainstorming

The team conducted a brainstorming session to generate possible solutions for improving the Standard Laptop procurement process.

All ideas were considered without immediately rejecting them. The main focus was to identify ways to reduce manual work and make the process faster and more reliable.

The following ideas were generated:

Idea 1: Continue Manual Task Creation

The Hardware configuration task can continue to be created manually after the laptop request is approved.

Idea 2: Send Notification to Hardware Team

A notification can be sent to the Hardware team when a Standard Laptop request is approved.

Idea 3: Automatically Create a Catalog Task

A system automation can automatically create a Catalog Task after the Standard Laptop request reaches the required approval stage.

Idea 4: Automatically Assign the Task

The generated Catalog Task can automatically be assigned to the Hardware group.

Idea 5: Use ServiceNow Flow Designer

ServiceNow Flow Designer can be used to automate the complete task creation and assignment process.

Idea 6: Standardize Task Information

The automatically created task can contain a predefined Short Description and Description so that the Hardware team receives clear instructions.

Idea 7: Track the Configuration Task

The Catalog Task can be linked to the Requested Item so that the task can be tracked from the laptop request.

Idea 8: Reduce Manual Intervention

The process can be designed so that repetitive administrative activities are handled automatically by ServiceNow.

2.2 Idea Listing

S.N0	Brainstormed Idea	Purpose
1	Manual task creation	Create configuration tasks manually
2	Hardware notification	Inform Hardware team about approved requests
3	Automatic Catalog Task	Create configuration task automatically
4	Automatic assignment	Assign task to Hardware automatically
5	Flow Designer automation	Automate the procurement workflow
6	Standard task information	Maintain consistent task details
7	Request task tracking	Track the configuration task
8	Reduce manual work	Minimize repetitive activities

2.3 Idea Grouping

The brainstormed ideas were grouped into major categories based on their purpose.

Group 1: Process Automation

Ideas related to automating the procurement workflow were grouped together.

- Automatic Catalog Task creation.
- ServiceNow Flow Designer.
- Automatic task assignment.
- Automatic processing after approval.

Group 2: Task Management

Ideas related to creating and managing configuration tasks were grouped together.

- Standard task description.

- Catalog Task creation.
- Requested Item connection.
- Task tracking.

Group 3: Communication

Ideas related to informing the Hardware team were grouped together.

- Hardware team notification.
- Request status communication.

Group 4: Efficiency Improvement

Ideas related to reducing manual effort and improving productivity were grouped together.

- Reducing repetitive work.
- Reducing processing delays.
- Improving resource utilization.
- Reducing the possibility of task oversight.

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

After listing and grouping the ideas, the team prioritized them according to their relevance to the identified problem.

The following factors were considered:

- Ability to reduce manual work.
- Ability to reduce delays.
- Ease of implementation.
- Integration with ServiceNow.
- Improvement in task assignment.
- Improvement in process consistency.
- Benefit to the Hardware team.
- Benefit to users.

3.1 Prioritized Ideas

Priority	Idea	Reason
1	Use ServiceNow Flow Designer	Provides workflow automation within ServiceNow
2	Automatically create Catalog Task	Reduces manual task creation
3	Automatically assign to Hardware	Ensures task reaches the appropriate team
4	Standardize task information	Provides consistent task details
5	Track task through Requested Item	Improves process visibility
6	Send notification	Supports communication with Hardware
7	Reduce repetitive work	Improves resource utilization
8	Continue manual task creation	Does not remove the identified manual effort

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Step-4: Selected Idea

Based on the brainstorming and prioritization process, the team selected **ServiceNow Flow Designer automation** as the main solution.

The selected idea is to create a Flow that automatically creates a Catalog Task for Standard Laptop configuration and assigns it to the Hardware group after the required approval stage.

Selected Solution

Standard Laptop Request

↓

Service Catalog

↓

Approval

↓

Flow Designer

↓

Create Catalog Task

↓

Assign to Hardware

↓

Laptop Configuration

Reason for Selecting the Idea

The Flow Designer solution directly addresses the main problem identified during brainstorming.

It can help:

- Automate task creation.
- Reduce manual intervention.
- Reduce processing delays.
- Assign tasks to the Hardware team.
- Maintain consistent task information.
- Improve resource utilization.
- Reduce the possibility of task oversight.
- Support faster laptop configuration.
- Improve the overall procurement process.

Step-5: Final Brainstorming Outcome

The brainstorming and idea prioritization process resulted in a clear project concept.

The team identified that the manual handling of Standard Laptop configuration tasks can be improved through automation.

The final concept is to use **ServiceNow Flow Designer** to create a Catalog Task automatically for an approved Standard Laptop request.

The Catalog Task will contain the required task information:

Short Description:
Laptop need to be Configured

Description:
Laptop need to be Configured

Assignment Group:
Hardware

Approval:
Approved

The Requested Item Record will be used while creating the Catalog Task so that the configuration task is associated with the relevant laptop request.

Final Idea Statement

> **To automate the creation and assignment of Standard Laptop configuration tasks using ServiceNow Flow Designer, thereby reducing manual intervention, minimizing delays, and improving the efficiency of the IT procurement process.**

Conclusion

The Ideation Phase helped the team understand the existing Standard Laptop procurement problem, generate multiple possible solutions, group the ideas, and prioritize the most relevant solution.

The final selected idea is **automating Standard Laptop configuration tasks using ServiceNow Flow Designer**.

This idea provides the foundation for the next phases of the project, including **Requirement Analysis, Project Design, Project Planning, Project Development, Testing, Documentation, and Demonstration**.